



Make DVDs Of Your AVIs

If you have a DVD drive and a DVD player, it's easy to convert your AVI files to DVD—and then watch them on your TV set

Varun Dubey

If you have AVI movies that you are tired of watching on your PC's small screen, and, in addition, you don't want to write them to a CD because of the loss in quality, here's how to convert your AVI files to DVD.

The most incredible thing about this is that the required software is absolutely free, and performs better than most of the paid versions we've seen!

You Will Need

- ❑ A DVD-Writer for burning the DVD. As of now, DVD-Writers retail for roughly Rs 4,500.
- ❑ The software, Avi2DVD, which can be found at <http://snipurl.com/e0ze>

1 STEP The Input

Post installation, firing up the software brings up a single window interface, which is akin to Nero's info tool. This is the command centre for all the encoding. There is an option to select from two input modes—AVI or DVD.

Since you would like to convert existing AVI files to DVD, you will need to choose the AVI mode. Interestingly, in the AVI mode, the software takes not only .AVI files, but also .OGM (Ogg Media files) and .MKV (Matroska Video files).



The options available at startup

2 STEP The Output

Here, you can select the output format for your movie file. You can choose between DVD, SVCD and VCD.

Then, using the drop-down menu, you can select the disk size that you are using. This ranges from 740 MB for a CD-ROM to 8.5 GB for a dual-layered (DL) DVD.

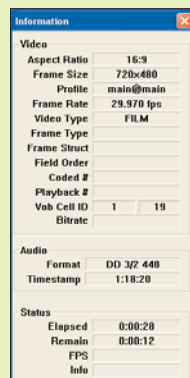
Remember, to burn a DL DVD, you need to have a DVD-Writer that supports DL writing, as well as compatible media.

You can also specify the screen aspect ratio—16:9 for wide-screen TVs, or 4:3 for regular TVs. The software even allows you to specify the video format—NTSC or PAL (PAL is the standard used in India).

A thoughtful addition is the ability to specify the number of disks you want to spread your movie across—the software splits the output file accordingly!

3 STEP Encoding

Once you have selected the output mode, you can select the codec you would like to encode your movie with.

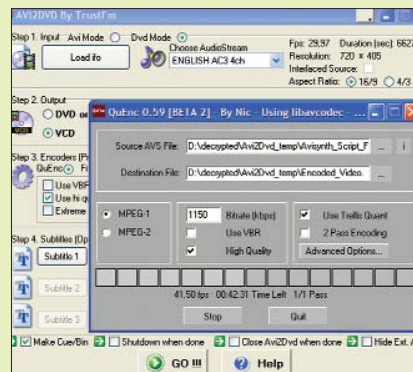


Here, choose the options you want for the actual encoding of the AVI file

Incidentally, the software offers four encoders by default. These are QuEnc, NuEnc, FreeEnc and HCEnc. All these are freely available, so you need not worry about payment or copyrights. They get installed with the software.

In our tests, we found that the encoders provided do a pretty good job. There are also various options such as VBR (Variable Bit Rate, which reduces file size without noticeable loss in quality), an option to set the output to High Quality with one click, and an option to set the number of passes for your movie encoding. The more the number of passes, the better the output will be.

If you are making a DVD, the software even allows you to add



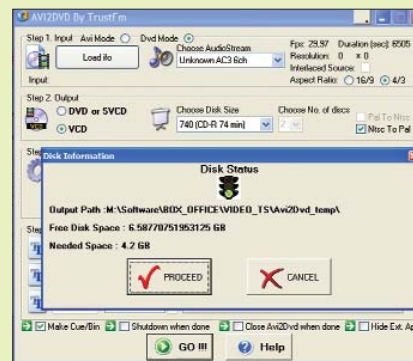
You get advanced options just prior to burning your DVD

subtitles to the movie. Moreover, you can select font type, size, colour margins, and even the language!

Using the software does not lead to any audio quality loss, and retains the number of channels your original file had.

4 STEP Burn It!

Once you have encoded your file, navigate to the directory where you saved the original file. You will find a folder called Avi2DVD_temp (or whatever folder name you specified).



When you're sure you've made all the correct choices, just burn your ready-to-view DVD!

Inside this, you will find the .CUE files. Burn these using your favourite writing software, and your DVD is ready!

varun_dubey@thinkdigit.com